crisis, echoing Latin American critiques. In Africa, land rights and economic exploitation have become rallying cries for populist leaders across the continent. In the Middle East, populist movements have also gained traction in democracies like Turkey, where Recep Tayyip Erdoğan has combined populism with authoritarianism, and Israel, where populist rhetoric has targeted elite institutions and foreign intervention.

These examples clearly show that populism transcends ideology, geography, and political systems. Whether emerging from the left or right, in wealthy democracies or developing nations, populists successfully mobilize discontent against elites. This enduring and adaptable appeal underscores populism's power to challenge established systems, including IOs, on a global scale.

3.2 Populism and the Evolution of IOs

The inherent tension between IOs as supranational governing entities and populism as a nationalist, anti-elite ideology has grown sharper as IOs have expanded in both scale and influence. This friction is rooted in a significant historical shift: While IOs have proliferated dramatically since World War II, their scope, authority, and autonomy have also deepened, making them both indispensable and polarizing players on the global stage.

The post–World War II international order was initially built on a foundation of a few major IOs with global reach and focused mandates. The Bretton Woods twins—the IMF and the World Bank—were designed to stabilize the global economy. The GATT provided a platform for trade negotiations, and the United Nations sought to prevent future military conflicts. These institutions were crafted to address the immediate challenges of the postwar world, namely economic reconstruction, monetary stability, and peacekeeping.

Fast forward to today, and these organizations have transformed into sprawling entities with expanded mandates. The GATT evolved into the WTO, which now enforces binding international trade rules. The IMF shifted its focus to emergency loans tied to stringent policy conditions. The World Bank diversified into infrastructure financing, climate change mitigation, and conditional development aid. Meanwhile, the UN has grown into a vast network of specialized agencies addressing issues from health to